Patrick Ferguson

pcf44@cornell.edu · patrickcferguson.github.io

Research Interests

Econometrics; partial identification; statistical decision theory under ambiguity; survey design

Education

Cornell University — Expected 2027
PhD Economics
Committee: Jörg Stoye (Chair), Francesca Molinari, José Luis Montiel Olea

University College Dublin — 2020
MSc Quantitative Economics

Trinity College Dublin — 2019
BA Economics and Psychology

Job Market Paper

Paying to Sharpen Identification: Optimal Probing of Coarse Data

Summary. I develop a framework for allocating costly refinement of coarse data to reduce identification uncertainty. For scalar expectations and univariate distributions under Wasserstein-1 distance, identified-set diameter decomposes into observation-level contributions, yielding a simple rule: probe observations in decreasing order of expected diameter reduction per unit cost. I illustrate the rule in two survey-design problems.

Working Papers

Statistical Treatment Choice with Untested Doses

Asymptotic Minimax Optimality of Plug-In Rules
with José Luis Montiel Olea and Jörg Stoye

Research & Teaching Experience

Research Assistantships

Francesca Molinari and Levon Barseghyan — Summer 2025
Stephen Coate — Summer 2023

Teaching Assistantships

Mathematical Economics (PhD) — Fall 2022–2025
Economics of Wages and Employment (UG) — Spring 2025
Microeconomic Theory II (PhD) — Spring 2024
Intermediate Microeconomics (UG) — Spring 2023

Awards

The Louis Walinsky Fund in Economics in Honor of Professor Herbert Joseph Davenport Outstanding Teaching Award — 2023

Sage Fellow, Cornell University — 2021–present

Denis Conniffe Medal, UCD — highest overall score in the MSc programme — 2020

Additional Information

Citizenship: Ireland

Software: LaTeX, R (proficient); Julia, Stata, MATLAB, Python (some experience).

References

Jörg Stoye (Chair)
Ta-Chung Liu Professor of Economics
Cornell University
stoye@cornell.edu

Francesca Molinari
Professor, School of Government and Policy
Johns Hopkins University
f-molinari@jhu.edu

José Luis Montiel Olea
Associate Professor of Economics
Cornell University
montiel.olea@gmail.com